

PROSPER AWUNI

Senior Cyber Security Engineer | Microsoft Sentinel and Security Information and Event Management Specialist

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PROFESSIONAL PROFILE

I am a Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP) and Senior Cyber Security Engineer with over five years of experience designing, implementing, and hardening security capabilities across complex enterprise environments. I specialise in Microsoft Sentinel Security Information and Event Management (SIEM) including Kusto Query Language (KQL) query development, analytics rules, and data connector configuration, alongside full administration of Microsoft Defender Extended Detection and Response (XDR) across endpoint, identity, and cloud workloads. I bring hands-on expertise managing and optimising security tooling across global hybrid infrastructure, including CrowdStrike Falcon endpoint detection and response, Azure Active Directory (Azure AD) / Microsoft Entra ID identity controls, and BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM). I am comfortable operating within a small, focused security team, taking technical ownership of security platforms, and reporting directly to senior stakeholders on risk posture, detection coverage, and security improvement programmes.

CORE SKILLS AND TECHNICAL STACK

- **SIEM Engineering:** Microsoft Sentinel (KQL analytics rules, data connectors, workbooks, SIEM optimisation, threat detection rule development), CrowdStrike Falcon Next-Generation SIEM (NG-SIEM), Splunk/Security Processing Language (SPL)
- **Endpoint and Extended Detection and Response (XDR):** CrowdStrike Falcon Prevent/Insight/Discover, Microsoft Defender for Endpoint (MDE), Microsoft Defender for Identity (MDI), Microsoft 365 Defender
- **Identity and Access Management (IAM):** Azure Active Directory / Microsoft Entra ID, Conditional Access, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA), Single Sign-On (SSO), BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM)
- **Infrastructure Security:** Check Point Harmony firewall, Mimecast email security, Tanium endpoint management, Microsoft Intune/Mobile Device Management (MDM)/Mobile Application Management (MAM)
- **Threat Detection and Response:** Alert triage, incident response, MITRE ATT&CK framework, threat hunting, NIST SP 800-61 incident management lifecycle
- **Scripting and Automation:** PowerShell, Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbook development
- **Vulnerability Management:** Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation (BAS), Tenable.io, AppCheck, Nessus
- **Frameworks:** NIST Cybersecurity Framework (CSF), CIS Controls, ISO 27001, Cyber Essentials+, MITRE ATT&CK

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Senior Cyber Security Analyst / Engineer | University of the Arts, London (UAL) *March 2025 - Present*

- Take technical ownership of the Microsoft Sentinel SIEM platform, developing and tuning KQL-based analytics rules, custom workbooks, and data connector integrations to maintain comprehensive visibility across cloud, endpoint, identity, and network data sources.
- Shape and continuously improve Microsoft Sentinel capability by designing new use cases, expanding MITRE ATT&CK coverage, and identifying and closing detection gaps through structured gap analysis.
- Manage and optimise CrowdStrike Falcon (Prevent, Insight, Discover, and NG-SIEM modules) across the enterprise estate, refining detection policies and ensuring complete endpoint visibility.
- Administer Microsoft Defender for Endpoint, Microsoft Defender for Identity, and Microsoft 365 Defender, configuring detection and response policies and driving cross-platform incident investigation and containment.

- Implement and harden identity security controls via Azure Active Directory / Microsoft Entra ID, including Conditional Access policy design, Multi-Factor Authentication (MFA) enforcement, Privileged Identity Management (PIM), and Single Sign-On (SSO) configuration.
- Lead incident response (IR) activities following the NIST SP 800-61 lifecycle, coordinating containment, eradication, recovery, and post-incident review processes.
- Develop and maintain Security Orchestration, Automation and Response (SOAR) playbooks using PowerShell and Microsoft Sentinel automation rules to reduce mean time to detect (MTTD) and mean time to respond (MTTR).
- Drive vulnerability management programmes using Pentera Breach and Attack Simulation, Tenable.io, and AppCheck, prioritising remediation based on business risk and regulatory requirements.
- Report on security risk posture, detection coverage, and key performance indicators (KPIs) to the IT Security Officer and senior leadership.

Cyber Security Analyst, Cyber Security and Identity | University of the Arts, London (UAL)

March 2022 - March 2025

- Monitored and investigated security alerts from the Sentinel SIEM platform and CrowdStrike Falcon, performing Tier 2 alert triage, investigation, and escalation with detailed root cause analysis.
- Developed and tuned KQL detection queries in Microsoft Sentinel to improve signal quality, reduce false positives, and surface genuine threat activity across cloud and hybrid infrastructure.
- Managed Azure Active Directory / Microsoft Entra ID security including Conditional Access policy creation, MFA deployment, and Identity Protection alert review.
- Administered CrowdStrike Falcon Prevent endpoint protection, managing detections, tuning exclusions, and coordinating endpoint isolation for confirmed incidents.
- Supported implementation of BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM), reducing privileged account exposure across Windows Server and cloud infrastructure.
- Maintained and optimised Mimecast email security, tuning anti-phishing, anti-spoofing, URL protection, and Data Loss Prevention (DLP) policies.
- Contributed to ISO 27001 and Cyber Essentials Plus compliance, providing technical evidence and supporting internal and external audit cycles.

IT Engineer: Security, Quality and Infrastructure | HICX Solutions Ltd (Software as a Service / FinTech)

February 2021 - March 2022

- Implemented and maintained information security controls across a cloud-based Software as a Service (SaaS) FinTech environment, ensuring alignment with ISO 27001 and CIS Controls.
- Managed endpoint security and device compliance via Microsoft Intune (Mobile Device Management/Mobile Application Management) and Azure Active Directory, enforcing security baselines across the estate.
- Conducted regular vulnerability assessments using Nessus, tracking findings to remediation and reporting risk posture to management.
- Delivered PowerShell scripting solutions to automate security and infrastructure management tasks, improving operational efficiency and consistency.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Took full technical ownership of Microsoft Sentinel SIEM at UAL, developing a structured library of KQL analytics rules aligned to MITRE ATT&CK, improving detection coverage across cloud, endpoint, and identity.
- Deployed Microsoft Defender for Endpoint and Microsoft Defender for Identity across an estate of over 8,000 users, significantly improving endpoint and identity threat visibility and reducing mean time to detect (MTTD).
- Designed and led the enterprise-wide rollout of CrowdStrike Falcon, integrating NG-SIEM telemetry with Microsoft Sentinel for unified cross-platform threat monitoring.
- Reduced mean time to respond (MTTR) by building automated SOAR playbooks in Microsoft Sentinel, enabling consistent, repeatable containment actions for common threat scenarios without manual analyst steps.

- Implemented BeyondTrust Privileged Access Management (PAM) to control and audit privileged access, materially reducing the risk from compromised administrator accounts.
 - Supported successful Cyber Essentials Plus certification by providing technical documentation and evidence across endpoint, identity, patch management, and network boundary controls.
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EDUCATION

- Master of Science (M.Sc.) in Environmental and Resource Engineering
 - Bachelor of Science (B.Sc.) in Chemical Engineering
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CERTIFICATIONS

- Certified Information Systems Security Professional (CISSP)
 - CompTIA Security+
 - Microsoft Certified Solutions Associate (MCSA)
 - CompTIA A+
 - Google IT Support Professional Certificate
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References available on request | Hybrid (London/UK)